

AV Production Software Roadmap

Phase 1 (Marketing) → Phase 2 (AV Production)

Revital is an AV production company that specializes in marketing. Right now the business is focused on marketing services to build revenue before launching the AV/live events side. This is the staged plan for gear and crew software, so we don't overpay for capacity we're not using yet, and don't create migration headaches when AV work actually starts.

PHASE 1 — Marketing Focus (current phase)

Trigger: Now, through today's marketing-only client work (portfolio-building clients, first paid marketing clients).

Tool	Use	Cost
Cheqroom	Internal gear/equipment tracking - checkout, calendar booking, kit/case tracking via QR. Fits our model because gear moves between our own crew and shoots, never out to an external paying renter.	~\$184/yr (~\$15/mo)
Rentman - Crew Essential only	Freelance crew scheduling for marketing/content shoots. Freelancer accounts are free; only the booking manager needs a paid seat. Inventory module stays OFF - no AV rental activity to justify it yet.	\$14/user/mo
QuickBooks	Invoicing - confirmed in use.	-
Stripe	Payment processing - confirmed in use.	-

Why Rentman (not a cheaper generic scheduler) even in Phase 1: AV production is a known Phase 2, not speculative. Choosing Rentman now means freelancer accounts and scheduling history carry straight through to Phase 2 - no re-onboarding freelancers to a new platform later.

Why not go all-in on Rentman Suite now: Inventory, transport, and on-site communication features are built for equipment leaving the building to a venue - that's not happening yet. Paying for it now is paying for unused capacity.

PHASE 2 — AV Production Launch

Trigger: The day we book our first paid AV/live event job - not before.

1. Upgrade to Rentman Suite

\$39/month, includes 1 free Power user. Adds the Inventory module alongside Crew, in the same account. No data migration - the freelancer roster and scheduling history from Phase 1 carry over automatically.

2. Retire Cheqroom

Re-tag physical gear with Rentman's auto-generated QR codes (each item gets its own, printable as small as 7mm x 7mm - works even for a microphone). Cheqroom's kit tracking becomes Rentman's "Combinations": physical combinations (fixed cases, always packed together) and virtual combinations (flexible kits, usually bundled but bookable individually).

3. Turn on Containers

Scan a transport case's QR code to see everything inside without opening it - the load-in/load-out check for live events.

4. Turn on Transport Scheduling + Crew Communication

Rentman's live-event-specific features: a load-in time change updates crew, gear, and transport together instead of three separate systems drifting out of sync.

Why switch instead of running both indefinitely: live events carry real coordination risk - a missed piece of gear or a crew member not shown up can break a show in a way that's more forgiving in pre-recorded content work. Rentman keeps crew, gear, and transport in sync automatically; running Cheqroom alongside it means paying for gear tracking twice and losing that sync.

What Stays Constant Across Both Phases

System	Role
QuickBooks + Stripe	All invoicing and payments, marketing or AV, routes through the same system.
ClickUp	CRM/deal tracking, campaign briefs, client feedback.
The Hub	Proposal Calculator, QC Checklist, Access & Login Log, Client Ad Account Log, and the rest of internal ops tooling. AV doesn't need new Hub tools yet - revisit once Phase 2 is live.

Cost Snapshot (Gear + Crew Only)

Phase	Monthly Software Cost
Phase 1 - Marketing	~\$29-30/mo (Cheqroom ~\$15 + Rentman Crew Essential \$14/user)
Phase 2 - AV Production	~\$39+/mo (Rentman Suite, 1 free Power user; Cheqroom retired)

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Revisit this doc the moment the first paid AV/live event booking is signed - that's the trigger to move to Phase 2.